# Income in the United States: 2023

## INTRODUCTION

The U.S. Census Bureau collects data and publishes estimates on income, earnings, and inequality in order to evaluate national economic trends and to understand their effect on the well-being of households, families, and individuals.

The estimates in this report are based on data collected in the 2024 and earlier Current Population Survey Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC) conducted by the Census Bureau.* This report presents estimates on income in the United States for calendar year 2023. Historical estimates are expressed in real or 2023 dollars to account for the change in the cost of living over time.[1] The current method for inflation-adjustment is based on the Chained Consumer Price Index for all Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U) between 2000 and 2023 and the Consumer Price Index for all Urban Consumers Retroactive Series (R-CPI-U-RS) prior to 2000.[2] The C-CPI-U measured a 4.0 percent increase in consumer prices between 2022 and 2023, down from a 7.7 percent increase between 2021 and 2022.

* The Census Bureau reviewed this data product to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data used to produce this product (Data Management System [DMS] number: P-7534374, Disclosure Review Board [DRB] approval number: CBDRB-FY24-0434). To further protect respondent privacy, all estimates in this report have undergone additional rounding. As a result, this year's estimates may differ from previous publications and details may not sum to totals. All comparative statements have undergone statistical testing and are statistically significant at the 90 percent confidence level unless otherwise noted.

This report begins with a section discussing median household income, highlighting year-to-year comparisons by characteristics such as race and Hispanic origin, nativity, region, and education. This is followed by sections on income inequality, workers, and median earnings. The income estimates in the main sections of this report are based on the concept of money income, which is pretax and does not account for the value of in-kind transfers. Estimates of post-tax income and inequality are included in Appendix B.

This report is released alongside two other reports focused on poverty estimates and health insurance coverage in the United States. For poverty and health insurance estimates, refer to "Poverty in the United States: 2023" and "Health Insurance Coverage in the United States: 2023."[3]

### Highlights

- Real median household income was $80,610 in 2023, a 4.0 percent increase from the 2022 estimate of $77,540 (Figure 1 and Table A-1). This is the first statistically significant annual increase in real median household income since 2019.[4]
- Real median household incomes increased by 5.4 percent for White households and by 5.7 percent for non-Hispanic White households between 2022 and 2023. There was no significant change in median incomes for Black, Asian, and Hispanic households (Figure 2 and Table A-1).
- Household income rose throughout the income distribution, increasing 6.7 percent at the 10th percentile and 4.6 percent at the 90th percentile (Table A-3).
- Income inequality as measured by the Gini index and income percentile ratios was not significantly different between 2022 and 2023 (Figure 3 and Table A-3).
- Between 2022 and 2023, the number of total workers increased by 2.2 million, or 1.3 percent. The change in the number of full-time, year-round workers was not statistically significant (Figure 5 and Table A-6).
- Real median earnings for men who worked full-time, year-round increased by 3.0 percent, and real median earnings increased 1.5 percent for women who worked full-time, year-round (Figure 4 and Table A-6).
- For full-time, year-round workers, the female-to-male earnings ratio in 2023 fell to 82.7 percent from 84.0 percent in 2022 (Figure 6 and Table A-6). This is the first statistically significant annual decrease in the female-to-male earnings ratio since 2003.

## HOUSEHOLD INCOME BY SELECTED CHARACTERISTICS

This section focuses on median household income by selected characteristics of the householder, including race and Hispanic origin, nativity, region, and education. The householder is the person (or

Table A-2.

## Households by Total Money Income, Race, and Hispanic Origin of Householder: 1967 to 2023

(Income in 2023 dollars, adjusted using the C-CPI-U (2000–2023) and R-CPI-U-RS (pre-2000). Households as of March of the following year. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar24.pdf>)

| Race and Hispanic origin of householder and year[1] | Number (thousands) | Percent distribution | | | | | | | | | | Median income (dollars) | | Mean income (dollars) | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Total | Under $15,000 | $15,000 to $24,999 | $25,000 to $34,999 | $35,000 to $49,999 | $50,000 to $74,999 | $75,000 to $99,999 | $100,000 to $149,999 | $150,000 to $199,999 | $200,000 and over | Estimate | Margin of error[2] (±) | Estimate | Margin of error[2] (±) |
| **ALL RACES** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 2023 | 132,200 | 100 | 7.4 | 6.7 | 6.9 | 10.3 | 15.7 | 12.1 | 17.0 | 9.5 | 14.4 | 80,610 | 634 | 114,500 | 1,098 |
| 2022 | 131,400 | 100 | 8.1 | 7.2 | 7.4 | 10.4 | 15.9 | 12.2 | 16.7 | 9.3 | 12.9 | 77,540 | 1,006 | 110,600 | 1,075 |
| 2021 | 131,200 | 100 | 8.1 | 7.4 | 7.2 | 9.9 | 15.3 | 11.9 | 16.4 | 9.3 | 14.4 | 79,260 | 678 | 114,600 | 1,153 |
| 2020[3] | 129,200 | 100 | 7.6 | 7.4 | 6.8 | 10.6 | 15.2 | 12.3 | 16.5 | 9.3 | 14.2 | 79,560 | 1,030 | 114,000 | 1,227 |
| 2019 | 128,500 | 100 | 7.3 | 7.0 | 6.7 | 10.6 | 15.5 | 11.9 | 17.1 | 9.4 | 14.6 | 81,210 | 1,069 | 115,900 | 1,232 |
| 2018 | 128,600 | 100 | 8.3 | 7.5 | 7.2 | 10.9 | 15.8 | 12.5 | 16.6 | 9.0 | 12.3 | 75,790 | 829 | 108,000 | 1,077 |
| 2017[4] | 127,700 | 100 | 8.4 | 7.8 | 7.5 | 11.3 | 15.5 | 12.1 | 16.3 | 8.7 | 12.5 | 74,810 | 647 | 107,300 | 1,148 |
| 2017 | 127,600 | 100 | 8.4 | 7.8 | 7.6 | 11.3 | 15.2 | 12.2 | 16.4 | 9.0 | 12.1 | 75,100 | 674 | 105,500 | 1,047 |
| 2016 | 126,200 | 100 | 8.6 | 7.8 | 7.8 | 11.4 | 15.8 | 12.3 | 16.3 | 8.6 | 11.5 | 73,520 | 893 | 103,500 | 961 |
| 2015 | 125,800 | 100 | 8.4 | 8.3 | 8.6 | 11.3 | 15.4 | 12.3 | 16.3 | 8.9 | 10.5 | 71,000 | 663 | 99,580 | 833 |
| 2014 | 124,600 | 100 | 9.3 | 8.7 | 8.8 | 11.5 | 15.9 | 12.4 | 15.4 | 8.3 | 9.8 | 67,360 | 810 | 95,080 | 921 |
| 2013[5] | 123,900 | 100 | 9.2 | 8.9 | 8.7 | 11.1 | 15.8 | 12.7 | 15.6 | 8.0 | 9.8 | 68,220 | 1,370 | 95,740 | 1,391 |
| 2013[6] | 123,000 | 100 | 9.1 | 9.3 | 8.5 | 11.8 | 16.4 | 12.8 | 15.5 | 7.9 | 8.7 | 66,130 | 578 | 92,490 | 1,045 |
| 2012 | 122,500 | 100 | 9.1 | 9.2 | 9.1 | 11.9 | 16.3 | 12.6 | 15.6 | 7.8 | 8.4 | 65,740 | 443 | 91,850 | 892 |
| 2011 | 121,100 | 100 | 9.3 | 8.9 | 9.1 | 12.4 | 16.4 | 12.6 | 15.2 | 7.8 | 8.4 | 65,750 | 542 | 91,520 | 795 |
| 2010[7] | 119,900 | 100 | 9.3 | 9.0 | 8.8 | 11.7 | 16.6 | 12.3 | 15.9 | 7.8 | 8.6 | 66,730 | 724 | 91,270 | 802 |
| 2009[8] | 117,500 | 100 | 8.5 | 8.6 | 9.0 | 11.9 | 16.4 | 12.8 | 16.2 | 7.8 | 8.8 | 68,340 | 481 | 93,320 | 549 |
| 2008 | 117,200 | 100 | 8.4 | 8.7 | 8.8 | 11.8 | 16.2 | 12.7 | 16.6 | 8.0 | 8.8 | 68,780 | 308 | 93,560 | 544 |
| 2007 | 116,800 | 100 | 8.0 | 8.6 | 8.0 | 11.8 | 16.3 | 12.8 | 16.9 | 8.4 | 9.1 | 71,210 | 326 | 95,840 | 550 |
| 2006 | 116,000 | 100 | 8.1 | 8.3 | 8.2 | 11.8 | 17.1 | 12.4 | 16.7 | 8.2 | 9.2 | 70,080 | 495 | 96,780 | 615 |
| 2005 | 114,400 | 100 | 8.5 | 8.5 | 8.2 | 11.8 | 17.0 | 12.7 | 16.5 | 8.1 | 8.8 | 69,310 | 381 | 94,770 | 588 |
| 2004[9] | 113,300 | 100 | 8.4 | 8.9 | 8.3 | 12.2 | 16.2 | 13.0 | 16.5 | 8.1 | 8.4 | 68,250 | 496 | 93,080 | 577 |
| 2003 | 112,000 | 100 | 8.4 | 8.9 | 8.4 | 11.7 | 16.4 | 12.9 | 16.5 | 8.3 | 8.4 | 68,350 | 488 | 93,200 | 561 |
| 2002 | 111,300 | 100 | 8.3 | 8.8 | 8.1 | 12.1 | 16.5 | 12.9 | 16.9 | 8.2 | 8.1 | 68,310 | 368 | 93,190 | 575 |
| 2001 | 109,300 | 100 | 8.0 | 8.7 | 8.2 | 11.9 | 16.8 | 13.2 | 16.8 | 8.1 | 8.4 | 68,870 | 346 | 94,930 | 622 |
| 2000[10] | 108,200 | 100 | 7.7 | 8.3 | 8.2 | 11.5 | 17.2 | 13.1 | 17.5 | 8.0 | 8.6 | 70,020 | 362 | 95,280 | 617 |
| 1999[11] | 106,400 | 100 | 7.6 | 8.4 | 8.6 | 11.5 | 17.1 | 13.0 | 17.4 | 8.1 | 8.3 | 70,210 | 539 | 94,430 | 806 |
| 1998 | 103,900 | 100 | 8.4 | 8.6 | 8.1 | 12.0 | 17.2 | 13.4 | 17.0 | 7.7 | 7.5 | 68,470 | 666 | 91,310 | 811 |
| 1997 | 102,500 | 100 | 8.7 | 9.0 | 8.6 | 12.2 | 17.3 | 13.5 | 16.5 | 7.3 | 6.9 | 66,050 | 502 | 88,690 | 816 |
| 1996 | 101,000 | 100 | 8.9 | 9.4 | 8.9 | 12.5 | 17.3 | 13.4 | 16.7 | 6.7 | 6.3 | 64,710 | 537 | 85,910 | 792 |
| 1995[12] | 99,630 | 100 | 9.0 | 9.4 | 9.0 | 12.4 | 18.1 | 13.5 | 16.1 | 6.7 | 5.8 | 63,770 | 606 | 84,090 | 757 |
| 1994[13] | 98,990 | 100 | 9.5 | 9.9 | 9.2 | 12.8 | 17.5 | 13.4 | 15.7 | 6.3 | 5.8 | 61,800 | 463 | 82,620 | 731 |
| 1993[14] | 97,110 | 100 | 10.0 | 9.8 | 8.9 | 13.0 | 17.9 | 13.2 | 15.5 | 6.3 | 5.4 | 61,150 | 470 | 81,090 | 721 |
| 1992[15] | 96,430 | 100 | 9.9 | 9.8 | 9.1 | 12.3 | 18.3 | 13.6 | 16.0 | 6.1 | 4.9 | 61,450 | 478 | 77,910 | 538 |
| 1991 | 95,670 | 100 | 9.7 | 9.4 | 8.9 | 12.7 | 18.4 | 14.0 | 15.7 | 6.3 | 4.9 | 61,960 | 491 | 78,000 | 528 |
| 1990 | 94,310 | 100 | 9.4 | 9.0 | 8.7 | 12.6 | 18.8 | 14.1 | 16.1 | 6.3 | 5.1 | 63,830 | 536 | 79,730 | 554 |

Footnotes provided at end of table.

Table A-6.

## Earnings Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics: 2022 and 2023

(Earnings in 2023 dollars, adjusted using the C-CPI-U. People 15 years and older, as of March of the following year, with earnings. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar24.pdf>)

| Characteristic | 2022 | | | 2023 | | | Percent change in number of workers (2023 less 2022)* | | Percent change in median earnings (2023 less 2022)* | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Number (thousands) | Median earnings (dollars) Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) | Number (thousands) | Median earnings (dollars) Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) | Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) | Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) |
| **PEOPLE WITH EARNINGS** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Total** | **170,900** | **49,860** | **686** | **173,100** | **50,310** | **217** | ***1.3** | **0.54** | **0.9** | **1.32** |
| **Sex** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Male | 90,380 | 54,870 | 1,124 | 91,270 | 56,280 | 490 | *1.0 | 0.68 | *2.6 | 2.03 |
| Female | 80,490 | 42,960 | 268 | 81,790 | 42,110 | 273 | *1.6 | 0.80 | *–2.0 | 0.78 |
| **Race[2] and Hispanic Origin** | | | | | | | | | | |
| White | 130,900 | 51,070 | 793 | 132,300 | 50,720 | 242 | *1.1 | 0.59 | –0.7 | 1.46 |
| White, not Hispanic | 102,800 | 54,050 | 290 | 103,300 | 55,100 | 757 | 0.5 | 0.67 | *1.9 | 1.34 |
| Black | 21,880 | 43,490 | 600 | 22,110 | 43,090 | 2,115 | 1.1 | 1.77 | –0.9 | 4.96 |
| Asian | 11,650 | 64,400 | 1,427 | 11,850 | 63,850 | 3,599 | 1.7 | 2.19 | –0.8 | 5.46 |
| Hispanic (any race) | 31,630 | 37,910 | 405 | 32,830 | 37,280 | 359 | *3.8 | 1.06 | *–1.7 | 1.31 |
| **Age** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Under 65 years | 157,900 | 50,910 | 708 | 159,500 | 50,700 | 233 | *1.0 | 0.50 | –0.4 | 1.32 |
| 15 to 24 years | 22,970 | 19,500 | 1,112 | 22,760 | 19,880 | 893 | –0.9 | 1.94 | 1.9 | 7.31 |
| 25 to 34 years | 37,650 | 49,640 | 1,050 | 37,780 | 50,160 | 479 | 0.4 | 0.98 | 1.1 | 2.23 |
| 35 to 44 years | 36,550 | 58,960 | 674 | 37,240 | 59,750 | 1,901 | *1.9 | 0.92 | 1.3 | 3.17 |
| 45 to 54 years | 32,790 | 62,530 | 948 | 33,190 | 61,190 | 510 | *1.2 | 1.01 | *–2.1 | 1.58 |
| 55 to 64 years | 27,990 | 57,270 | 1,540 | 28,500 | 57,490 | 2,169 | *1.8 | 1.40 | 0.4 | 4.51 |
| 65 years and older | 12,930 | 41,270 | 2,188 | 13,590 | 39,390 | 2,190 | *5.1 | 3.36 | –4.5 | 6.25 |
| **Educational Attainment** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Total, aged 25 and older** | **147,900** | **54,180** | **225** | **150,300** | **54,970** | **784** | ***1.6** | **0.57** | ***1.5** | **1.38** |
| No high school diploma | 9,167 | 32,180 | 470 | 9,430 | 31,240 | 349 | 2.9 | 3.95 | *–2.9 | 1.67 |
| High school, no college | 36,830 | 42,100 | 302 | 37,480 | 41,420 | 314 | 1.8 | 1.94 | *–1.6 | 0.99 |
| Some college | 36,760 | 48,970 | 526 | 37,260 | 50,010 | 629 | 1.4 | 1.86 | *2.1 | 1.60 |
| Bachelor's degree or higher | 65,150 | 78,250 | 690 | 66,120 | 77,910 | 1,899 | *1.5 | 1.36 | –0.4 | 2.42 |
| **FULL-TIME, YEAR-ROUND WORKERS WITH EARNINGS** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Total** | **121,400** | **62,460** | **431** | **121,300** | **61,440** | **249** | **Z** | **0.78** | ***–1.6** | **0.69** |
| **Sex** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Male | 68,570 | 64,830 | 517 | 68,470 | 66,790 | 564 | –0.1 | 0.98 | *3.0 | 1.11 |
| Female | 52,790 | 54,440 | 368 | 52,850 | 55,240 | 628 | 0.1 | 1.04 | *1.5 | 1.15 |
| Female-to-male earnings ratio | X | 0.840 | 0.0073 | X | 0.827 | 0.0107 | X | X | *–1.5 | 1.38 |
| **Race[2] and Hispanic Origin** | | | | | | | | | | |
| White | 92,630 | 62,990 | 282 | 92,250 | 62,040 | 295 | –0.4 | 0.86 | *–1.5 | 0.54 |
| White, not Hispanic | 73,020 | 67,720 | 949 | 72,140 | 69,070 | 1,688 | *–1.2 | 0.98 | 2.0 | 2.51 |
| Black | 15,880 | 52,720 | 503 | 16,060 | 51,960 | 497 | 1.1 | 2.57 | *–1.4 | 1.26 |
| Asian | 8,622 | 83,490 | 2,989 | 8,657 | 81,020 | 1,291 | 0.4 | 2.99 | –3.0 | 3.55 |
| Hispanic (any race) | 22,030 | 47,220 | 622 | 22,680 | 46,880 | 497 | *3.0 | 1.69 | –0.7 | 1.47 |
| **Age** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Under 65 years | 114,800 | 62,430 | 615 | 114,600 | 61,450 | 262 | –0.1 | 0.77 | *–1.6 | 0.96 |
| 15 to 24 years | 8,845 | 36,630 | 620 | 8,722 | 36,670 | 509 | –1.4 | 4.03 | 0.1 | 2.03 |
| 25 to 34 years | 28,890 | 56,370 | 1,835 | 28,230 | 57,450 | 1,070 | *–2.3 | 1.36 | 1.9 | 3.59 |
| 35 to 44 years | 29,070 | 66,300 | 2,651 | 29,560 | 66,070 | 716 | *1.7 | 1.52 | –0.4 | 3.88 |
| 45 to 54 years | 26,590 | 68,910 | 1,009 | 26,650 | 70,370 | 747 | 0.2 | 1.69 | *2.1 | 1.65 |
| 55 to 64 years | 21,360 | 65,440 | 2,184 | 21,470 | 67,430 | 1,988 | 0.5 | 1.84 | 3.0 | 4.15 |
| 65 years and older | 6,601 | 62,990 | 861 | 6,689 | 61,170 | 818 | 1.3 | 4.58 | *–2.9 | 1.51 |

Footnotes provided at end of table.

Table A-6.

## Earnings Summary Measures by Selected Characteristics: 2022 and 2023—Con.

(Earnings in 2023 dollars, adjusted using the C-CPI-U. People 15 years and older, as of March of the following year, with earnings. Information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, and definitions is available at <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/techdocs/cpsmar24.pdf>)

| Characteristic | 2022 | | | 2023 | | | Percent change in number of workers (2023 less 2022)* | | Percent change in median earnings (2023 less 2022)* | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Number (thousands) | Median earnings (dollars) Estimate | Median earnings (dollars) Margin of error[1] (±) | Number (thousands) | Median earnings (dollars) Estimate | Median earnings (dollars) Margin of error[1] (±) | Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) | Estimate | Margin of error[1] (±) |
| **Educational Attainment** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Total, aged 25 and older** | **112,500** | **63,720** | **248** | **112,600** | **63,640** | **1,404** | **0.1** | **0.79** | **–0.1** | **2.14** |
| No high school diploma | 6,120 | 38,260 | 627 | 6,266 | 37,000 | 588 | 2.4 | 5.18 | *–3.3 | 1.96 |
| High school, no college | 27,480 | 48,490 | 430 | 27,540 | 48,810 | 1,058 | 0.2 | 2.33 | 0.6 | 2.35 |
| Some college | 27,610 | 55,290 | 1,335 | 27,350 | 56,740 | 470 | –1.0 | 2.16 | *2.6 | 2.52 |
| Bachelor's degree or higher | 51,290 | 86,890 | 2,824 | 51,450 | 89,410 | 2,502 | 0.3 | 1.59 | 2.9 | 4.04 |

* An asterisk preceding an estimate indicates change is statistically different from zero at the 90 percent confidence level.

X Not applicable.

Z Rounds to zero.

[1] A margin of error (MOE) is a measure of an estimate's variability. The larger the MOE in relation to the size of the estimate, the less reliable the estimate. This number, when added to and subtracted from the estimate, forms the 90 percent confidence interval. MOEs shown in this table are based on standard errors calculated using replicate weights.

[2] Federal surveys give respondents the option of reporting more than one race. Therefore, two basic ways of defining a race group are possible. A group, such as Asian, may be defined as those who reported Asian and no other race (the race-alone or single-race concept) or as those who reported Asian regardless of whether they also reported another race (the race-alone-or-in-combination concept). This table shows data using the first approach (race alone). The use of the single-race population does not imply that it is the preferred method of presenting or analyzing data. The Census Bureau uses a variety of approaches. Data for American Indians and Alaska Natives, Native Hawaiians and Other Pacific Islanders, and those reporting Two or More Races are not shown separately.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 2023 and 2024 Annual Social and Economic Supplements (CPS ASEC).